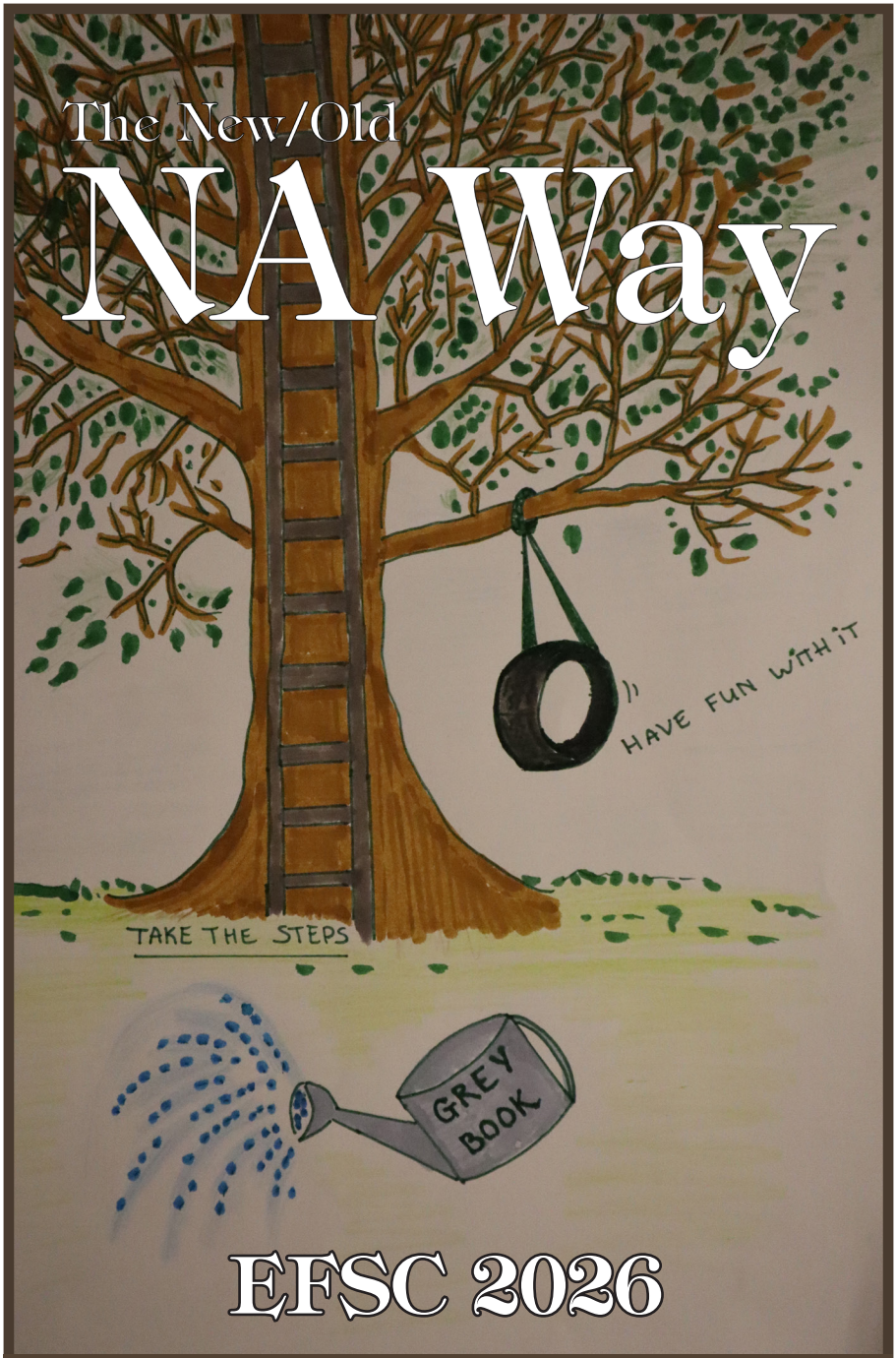
The New/Old NA Way



EFSC 2026

Volume 64 - September 2026



The New/Old NA WAY Magazine
Volume 64 - September 2026

This magazine was written in open participation by members of the Groups of The Anonymi Foundation and members of the Groups who participate in the Fellowship Service Conference and the European Felloswhip Service Conference

The New/Old NA Way

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My Gratitude Speaks
When I Care
And When I Share
With Others
The NA Way

The Insanity of Relationships in Early Recovery

Insanity can follow us into recovery long after we stop using drugs. When we first come to NA, many of us are still looking outside ourselves for something to fill the emptiness inside. Instead of drugs, we may become obsessed with relationships, sex, attention, approval, dating, or another person. We can quickly make someone else the centre of our world and call it love, while the same old addictive thinking is still running our lives.

Many of us have seen this pattern again and again. We come into NA, meet someone, become intensely involved, and slowly lose focus on meetings, our sponsor, the fellowship and ourselves. We start hiding things, isolating, becoming dishonest or depending on another person to make us feel okay. When the relationship ends, the pain can feel unbearable and the obsession can start all over again.

Step One reminds us where this road can take us. Our problem is not only the drugs. Addiction can show itself through obsession, compulsion, self-centredness and the desire to escape our feelings. Whether we face heartbreak, loneliness, grief or the loss of someone we love, staying clean means we can no longer numb every painful feeling. We have to learn to feel it, share it and walk through it.

Recovery gives us a new way of living. We build relationships with our sponsor, our fellows and people who support our recovery. We learn honesty, boundaries, patience and responsibility. Instead of expecting another person to complete us, we begin to develop a relationship with ourselves and with God.

We do not have to repeat the same insanity. By working the Steps, staying connected to NA and building a relationship with God, we find a freedom that no relationship, person or drug could ever give us. The answer is step work and *God*.

Life is not just a glum lot, we become happy, joyous and free!

Coming Into Narcotics Anonymous (ENGLISH)

The Fellowship of NA is a world of its own. When you first walk in, you'll come into contact with a lot of new people, customs, and words. This guide is here to help you find your way.

At some point you'll come to see that the recovering addicts in NA are, quite simply, just people too. Everyone in NA is here because on their own they couldn't stay clean, or couldn't cope with life while clean. We're all here to learn a new way of living and to help each other do that. It starts with staying clean. Personal growth depends on our growth together in NA.

Meet your greeter

Before you even walk into the meeting, someone will probably greet you very enthusiastically and ask if you'd like a hug. Don't be alarmed! This is the greeter, who will try to put you at ease and show you where the meeting is.

Walking into NA for the first time can feel pretty awkward. Saying your name and stating that you're an addict is bound to feel uncomfortable. Some words can be confusing — addict, sponsor, fellowship, service work — and even the word God might make you want to run as far away as possible. Still, if you give yourself a chance, you'll find you've landed in a warm bath, and that you'll quickly come out of your loneliness and isolation and start experiencing joy and fun in your life again.

Join the resistance or the cult?

An addict wrote: "Eventually, after searching, trying, running, and hiding, we went to our first meeting. Candles, hugs, and standing in a circle at the end to pray. The first time, I thought they'd do what football teams do, as a joke. But no, they were serious. They prayed all in one voice. It was strange. I also thought I knew better than those people — especially after I heard the sentence that the NA way is the only way. Is it? I don't know, but I do know it works for me. Then the whole total-abstinence thing hit me. I'd only come to stop smoking weed, and wished them well. But I got completely clean, and it became my way of life, and these people became crucial and important to me. To stay honest, every now and then I still struggle to find a healthy and peaceful way to deal with myself and others.

I'm so grateful to the person who once invited me along. Within five minutes I'd had 30 hugs and made a lot of friends. Still, at first it felt like I'd ended up in a cult. But everything in me said I was home. So if you're thinking the same thing, be patient, because it gets better."

In the beginning, most of us didn't think we were that bad. We found the people at the meetings very strange, almost cult-like. Do we really have to be around these people for the rest of our lives? I'm not like these people. The people were laughing, hugging each other, and we heard words we'd never heard before. They told us to keep coming back to the meetings. We did, despite a lot of resistance and diseased thinking. In the beginning, most of our families were very happy that we were going to meetings. Later on, they would sometimes get annoyed that we had to go so often and spend so much time on it. This often made us feel bad about it.

Maybe you don't feel this yet, and you're afraid. All those judgments and fears. Do you run, or do you give it a chance? Today, we're grateful that we can grow as people, that we dare to face our fears, and that we always have a home. And those hugs? We wouldn't want to miss them anymore.

Our friends and family find it strange at first, but they're often relieved that we're no longer using. We didn't really know what was happening ourselves, except that we had to keep coming back and find a sponsor to work the program. Once we'd found our footing after a while clean, our loved ones would wonder: do you still need this? Why do you go to so many meetings? When will you be done?

The answer to those questions comes with time, through the change in character we go through by continuing to come back and keep working the program. Because we can only keep what we have by giving it away.

Trust the proces

When we first came to meetings, we heard about sponsorship and working with a sponsor. Some of us hoped, or thought, that finding a sponsor as soon as possible would be the solution to our problems. We found out it's part of our recovery, but not something we need right away. We can take the time to get to know the place we walked into. We learned that by attending meetings regularly, we could get clean and stay clean. And that's already a big change from how it used to be.

Very often we wanted to leave because we thought we knew better. We held off going to things like events because we were scared to step out of our comfort zone — we felt like we wouldn't fit in.

How do you survive NA? For some of us it was very simple: keep coming back. Start with the tools, and try to keep an open mind as best you can. We believe wonderful things have happened for us since starting this program; even after a few years clean, new things still seem possible, and there's still a lot to learn.

Whats on that table?

A great way to get some more understanding about the place you walked into is by reading literature and asking questions. If you are like us you probably think you already know everything, or should know everything. But we learned that the best way to learn is to open up our mind for new ideas and admit that we have lots to learn.

In NA we learn how to live.



Recovery Poem

Service in recovery is what we heard 1000 times,
When you see addicts working in Unity, it is the Spirit of recovery that shines,
We go from dark to light, from hate to love,
When push comes to shove, it is being content and having enough,
An attitude of gratitude is always right for our minds.

A feeling of gratitude, is what left us fulfilled,
We see al these miracles, our lives are rebuilt,
Gratitude is not only shown in words,
God and the Fellowship are putting us to work,
By gratitude in action, we are freed from our guilt.

Recovery without action, is a butterfly without wings,
Without it recovery never begins,
It all starts with that first admission,
Since the day, Jimmy had his vision,
Only through complete surrender the disease never wins.

Through our surrender we learn to give up the fight,
Now at the end of the tunnel, there's freedom in sight,
Only than we could see who we truly are,
Because the battle we couldn't win, didn't get us that far,
This way we recover, with God as our guide!!

How do we apply the spiritual principles at the EFSC?

We have a group of 8 people, and 6 of them are here at the EFSC for the first time.

We were inspired to write about how we live out the spiritual principles here at the EFSC.

We used a few of the spiritual principles from the booklet *When It Works*.

Hope:

That we, as individuals, may serve as instruments of God to fulfill our primary purpose

To reach out and help the still suffering addict.

Surrender:

We notice that there are moments here when we're self-centered and want to do things our own way. Fortunately, we're each other's eyes and ears, so we can't get away with it.

So right now, we're faced with the choice to surrender.

Acceptance:

Accepting what is happening within us at every moment—the emotions, the feelings, the frustration, the loneliness, and the fear. In every moment, we must acknowledge and accept our powerlessness.

Honesty:

Being honest with ourselves about what we feel and think.

And sharing this with the people we trust, such as our sponsors or fellows.

Open-mindedness:

Listening to the information even if we don't understand it yet and it doesn't resonate with us yet.

Unconditional love:

All the love in our lives—whether in reality or in our perception—has always been conditional. If we didn't behave as expected, or if we said what we really thought, there were—or still are—consequences.

And then you come to NA, to your first meeting and later to your first event. You aren't judged, punished, or excluded. You are accepted for who and what you are.

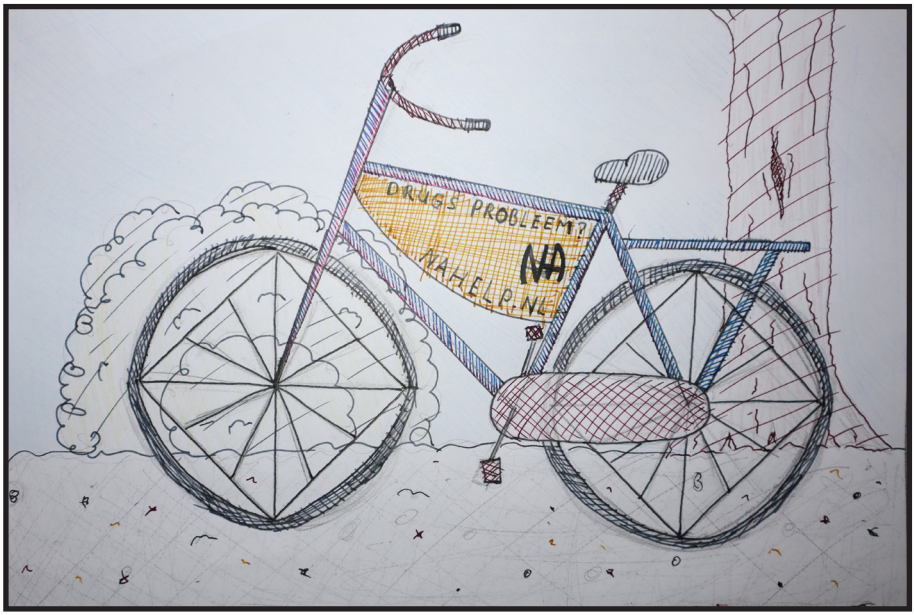
The discomfort is palpable. The masks no longer work. The fear is there, but you find no confirmation of rejection in your interactions with others. You find Hope, Surrender, Acceptance, Honesty, Open-mindedness, Willingness, Faith, Tolerance, Patience, Humility, Sharing and caring. You find Unconditional Love.

Blessed In Recovery From Africa

I'm an addict, seven years clean, I went to rehab in 2019, I started counting my clean date since then, my clean date is 11 July 2019. NA was there in treat-

ment and I used to attend those meetings. Members shared and read the reading cards, I identified with the shares and the reading cards spoke to me, and that is when I saw that I'm an addict. I haven't relapsed ever since. They always said "keep coming back", didn't understand that at first, still trying to figure that out even today, I carried that with me. I still come back to meetings. I found myself a home group, and I'm a member and a trusted servant. I was given a hug by a member and was offered a cup of coffee at my first NA meeting, what a warm welcome.

I'm clean and free from chemical dependency. I'm not working and struggle financially, I apply for jobs, sometimes I don't even know where my next plate of food is going to come from, I have a roof over my head and a bed to sleep in, I registered a NPC, and I'm a candidate as a PR councilor of my organization - political party, chosen by the people and members of the political party, a productive member of society, at home, and my whole entire family thanks to Narcotics Anonymous. I dress up and show up. I participate in my life and the fellowship, inside and outside. I'm fully present and aware. Communication is a two-way street. Love and



tolerance. Key is acceptance. The are times where I feel like quitting or committing suicide, through prayer and meditation, working the steps and the traditions, being of service, having a sponsor, connecting and making meetings I'm able to face life - clean, and I understand that things are the way they should be - life on life's terms. The journey is a feeling of gratitude. They said to me they will love me until I learned to love myself. The answers are in our literature and I keep NA members close to me at all times.

I thought NA only existed in my area, it was said to me "we pick up information as we talk to members and visit various groups", I did that , the more I connected and took numbers the more I got exposed to Narcotics Anonymous. I started attending NA events, and members were good to me, they took me to those events and drove me to meetings. Then covid came and it was lock down, I started making online meetings that is when I met addicts from all walks of life. I made sure I had connection to make the online meetings, made means and ways.

Coincidences are miracles in which God choses to remain anonymous "just stick around and watch the miracles happen and they will" you will soon see the sense and patterns of our meetings, I put my recovery first no matter what. I reach out, I know that I'm not alone. The member with the most clean time is the one who woke up early today. The journey continues. This is a just for today program. I expect nothing of nothing, zero expectations. I maintain a positive attitude. I pray and meditate. I journal and write a gratitude list. I'm not perfect and what I can tell you is that I didn't come here to get or be good, I'm here to recover. "It works if you work it, it won't if you don't". I am learning to live a new way of life. Life moves fast when you enjoying it. We do recover.

I enjoy living, good and bad, negative and positive. Recovery is a lifestyle. Practice Good Will. Learn to understand than to be understood. Walking to meetings helped me a lot. I used to walk miles / kilometers to meetings, irregardless of the weather conditions. "Get yourself to a meeting, coming back don't worry and reach out when you get there " Learn to love than to be loved. More will be revealed. It's a journey that has no destination. Keep your head/mind where your feet are. Recovery is a ongoing process. My understanding deepens everyday, the more I stay. If you want to stay stopped you are at the right place. I love newcomers and keep them close. We are all equal in NA. Awareness is a feeling. I love Narcotics Anonymous. We help ourselves by helping others.

Thank God for NA and NA for God.

Mmuso N ,Soweto, Johannesburg, Gauteng ,South Africa, 1852

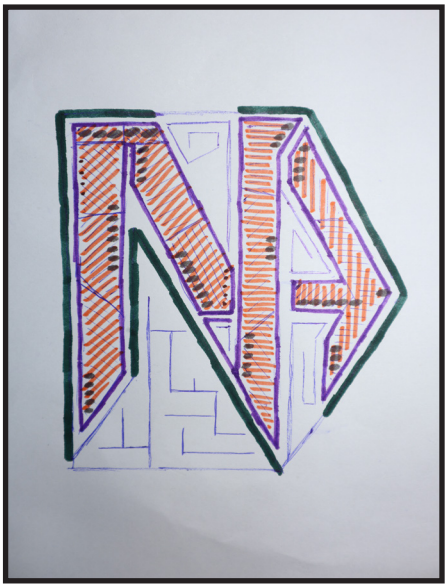
Surrender

We start by taking a risk to trust the program.

This feels foreign and scary at first, by nature we are self-seeking and selfobsessed beings. Our tendency is to run, hide, avoid and deny. We seem to like being in the dark with our fears and lack of control. For a long time we've lived with a false sense of security, seeking control.

This happens when we take ourselves too seriously.

What the program teaches us is how we are our own worst enemies. We have a lot of thoughts, ideas and think we know what's best and usually go in selfdestruction mode.



Gradually, as we stay we gain freedom.

We learn how to live, this is a daily process of showing up and risking to trust others.

These changes come slowly in our daily living, through showing up we see how we want to react and how we now have a choice to do differently.

We learn to focus on actions instead of feelings and ideas, we don't have to act out.

The disease slowly loses its grip on us, we are learning that we're being helped and that help can come from a lot of places, we can ask for it by reaching out.

We receive it through others, in meetings, phone calls literature and other sources.

Through this we learn principle, surrender and willingness.

Surrender is often tied to action, as we grow we become more conscious of the awareness that we have a choice. We don't have to believe our thoughts, we learn to ask for help BEFORE shit hits the fan.

Surrender is different in every situation.

It's action and inaction and we learn how to respond to different situations.

We surrender by staying and learning as we go.

We're in an uphill journey instead of an uphill battle.

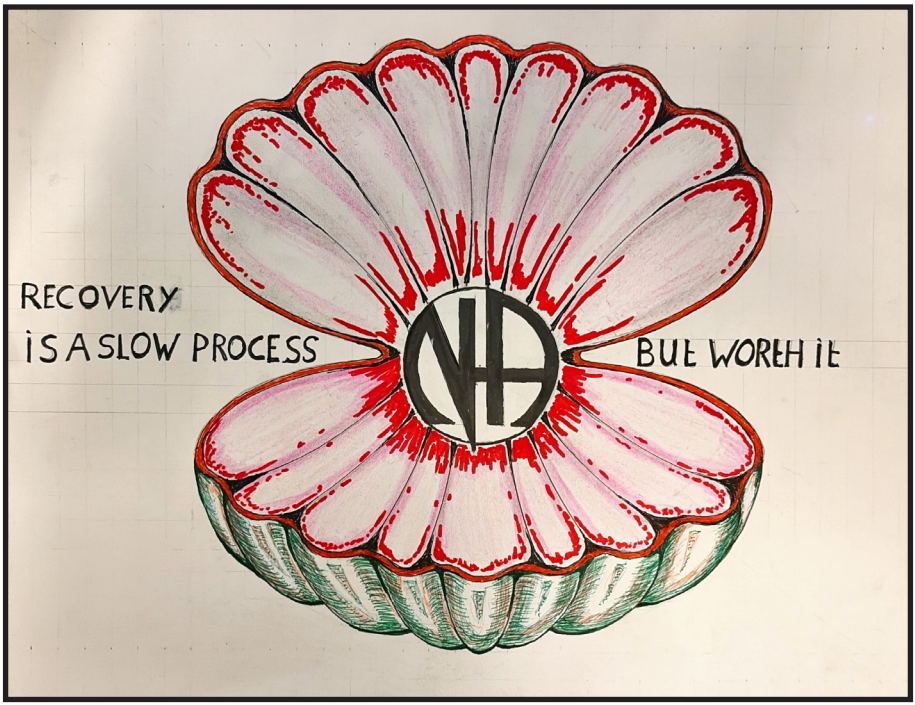
An experience of an NA event

I had only been in NA for a few months when the EFSC was coming up, and my sponsor and other fellows asked if I wanted to go along. I didn't know what I could expect, but they were all so enthousiastic that I said yes. I did't get time off at work, so I drove to Zevenaar alone on Friday and arrived in the evening. I felt al lot of tense, I didn't know the most of the others. Everyone had already arrived and introduced themselves by Thursday. I felt very uncomfortable and like an intruder, felt like I didn't belong.

In the kitchen they needed help, and it felt safe to stay there and not in the group. The whole EFSC I hide myself in the kitchen, isolating myself. I didn't want to be a lart of the group, out of fear of rejection and of being not good enough. At the end of the EFSC we had come in front to the desk and share our vision for the coming year. I didn't step forward because again the fear; I didn't want to be the centre of attention with everybody looking at me.

The second year the same happened. The fear was great then the desire to be with the group.

The third year I stayed with the group, but I didn't contribute



anything; after all, what did my input matter?

Promoting my vision? No way, count me out. It was suggested that I go up with my sponsor. I felt so pressurred that I panicked and ran outside I to the rain, crying.

I prayed a few serenity prayers and asked for calmness and sure enough....I went inside walked to the desk and shared my vision for the coming year-and guess what? It didn't even hurt, no one did anything to me or said something negative. From that moment on, I started to grow, I dared to contribute something to my Home Group and stepped out of my comfort zone. I still feel fear and uncertainty, but I have a choice; do I stay stuck in that fear and uncertainty or do I trust my Higher Power and face it head-on?

Today I trust in God. I open up to my sponsor and fellows, and I confront my fear. I no longer have to do it alone. I look forward to the EFSC every year, and I am grateful and happy to be a part of it. The fear and uncertainty diminish each year, reducing my inner stress. I confront my comfort zone and my fears and as a result, I can tell a newcomer what a fantastic event this is-that I understand the fear and uncertainty, but that they fade over time as a rely on God's help, the Program and the fellows.

I am grateful for this experience and the growth. I have achieved so far, and I look forward to growing further as a person and a fellow. I am grateful for the opportunity to contribute to carrying the message to the still-suffering addict.

I CAN'T DO IT, WE CAN



What if

There i found myself,
lost in the dark.

In the middle of the crowd,
all alone.

Doing what i always did,
expecting something else.

Running in circles,
going nowhere.

Talking to myself,
out loud.

Making empty promises,
never to keep.

Holding on,
while falling deep.

When it suddenly hits me,
what if i just let go.





I'm P, and I'm an addict.

I wrote something down that I would like to share with you.

First of all, I want to thank all of you for being here. I thought today was a very beautiful and inspiring day, with a lot of interesting information, but also with a lot of emotions involved.

Because of that, I personally felt a little overwhelmed this evening, so I took some time for myself to process everything.

This is my first EFSC, and I'm grateful for the opportunity to be here.

I also think that a lot of things have been organized very well this weekend. We have a great program, with enough time and space to have good conversations with each other, but also to have fun together.

There is enough time to rest, and the food is absolutely delicious.

Personally, I think the people who made all of this possible deserve a round of applause.

For now, I wish everyone a good night's rest, so that tomorrow we can all come back refreshed and ready for another day together.

Thank you, everyone.

A new way of life

Our Basic Tekst tells us that every addict can stop using, lose the desire to use and find a new way of life. Many of us came in defeated, filled with fear, anger and resentments.

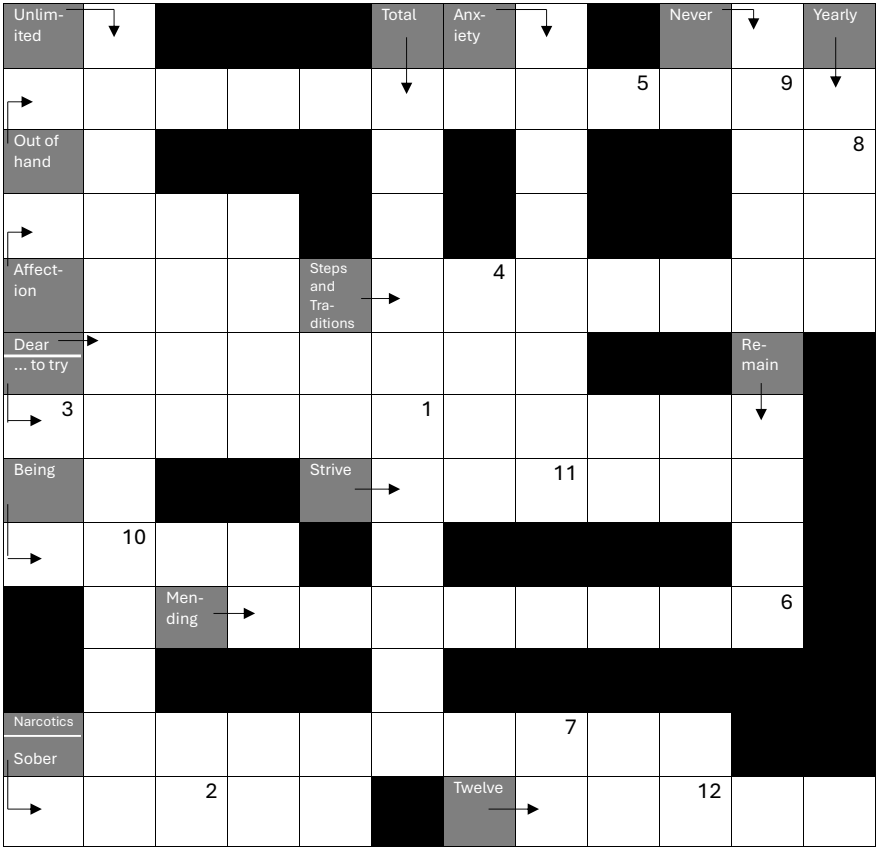
We felt useless, desperate and had no idea how to live life. We wanted to live but didn't know how. A lac of unconditional love and self-worth had resulted in an emptiness that we tried to fill with obsession we had no control over. We didn't understand ourselves or why we did things. After a few NA meetings we learned we had a disease called addiction. As we kept coming back we found out that we had to surrender to a new way of life. At the meetings our desperation changed in to hope. We felt seen by hearing other people share what was going on inside us. We were no longer alone. Welcome Home in Narcotics Anonymous. Never alone Never again.



Straight Ahead

Hello my friends
So happy to see you again
I was so alone
All by myself
I just could not make
Home again
Now we walk this journey together
On and on
Keep on pushin
Straight Ahead

Swedish Recovery Puzzel



1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12

Welcome home

From the depths of our addiction, we found a door that was open. We walked in as newcomers and were welcomed with open arms.

We no longer knew who we were or how to live.

Step by step, we let go. We're learning to trust ourselves again. Step by step, we're building a new life.

I Feel at Home

I walked in with empty hands, with eyes full of stories,

With a heart that no longer knew what it was looking for.

And now I have found something, something I never knew I needed.

What I have found is open arms and someone who helps me carry on.

Letting go, little by little, learning to trust myself again,

Step by step, I'm building a different life.

Not alone, but side by side — here I feel at home, here I feel free.

Welcome Home 2

They say "welcome home" when we walk through the door of the meeting as a newcomer. This suggests that we're in the right place as addicts. If we can acknowledge our powerlessness and hopelessness, and we are open to help, we can soon see that we, as addicts, have many things in common. We know what it's like to be beaten by addiction, so we are grateful that there are people there to help. If the group follows its primary purpose, we feel very welcome and looked after when we come into the room. This is where empathy does its work. Helping others in NA is the most rewarding thing we can do — giving of ourselves, caring for one another, is what we learn. And since a newcomer is just like us, full of fear, it is part of ourselves that we take care of. That's how we feel welcomed home. Staying clean with the help of the group, finding a sponsor and a home group, we take our place in the home group, we take our place in the fellowship of NA. At some point we can say that it feels like a new family, a place where we always feel at home, and where we can greet a new person with a warm welcome home.

At NA You Can Come Home

Just as you are, with everything you carry with you. Here you are welcomed with warmth, kindness, and understanding — a place where you can feel safe, where trust can grow, and where you know you are not alone.

We are in this together. We listen to one another, stand beside each other, and take each other seriously.

We share our experiences, support one another, and walk this journey together.

We share hope, love, and strength. Especially when life feels difficult, we remind each other that there is always hope for a new beginning.

Together, we find our way,
Together, we grow,
Together, we keep hope alive.

Coming Home

The literature describes that two addicts sharing recovery is already a meeting.

This describes my first feelings and experience coming to NA.

When I was still in active addiction, in a window of desperation and open-mindedness, I came into contact with a fellow addict who was in recovery.

I felt defeated, desperate, and fearful.

Today, the connection and recognition I experience within the fellowship seem almost natural.

Back then, however, it felt like a miracle — almost as if someone could read my mind.

I had felt lonely for a long time, with or without drugs, friends, or family.

The feelings I felt at that moment are almost indescribable — feelings I hadn't felt in a long time.

I felt seen, heard, and recognized. I didn't have to feel lonely again.

I felt at home.



Felt Lost

Felt lost for so long,

Didn't know where I belonged.

Waiting for life to get better,

And it felt like it took forever.

Same routine every day,

It felt like there was no other way.

Neglected myself and everyone around me,

No future dreams, no idea where I wanted to be.

Thought there was no way out,

Didn't know what life was about.

Questioned myself: Who am I?

Like my life was on standby.

That's over now,

I can let my guard down.

Since NA, I don't have to do it alone,

Because I finally feel at home.

I feel loved, and I am learning how to live my life

With my fellows and friends by my side.

Never have to go back to the old days,

Learning to deal with things in new ways.

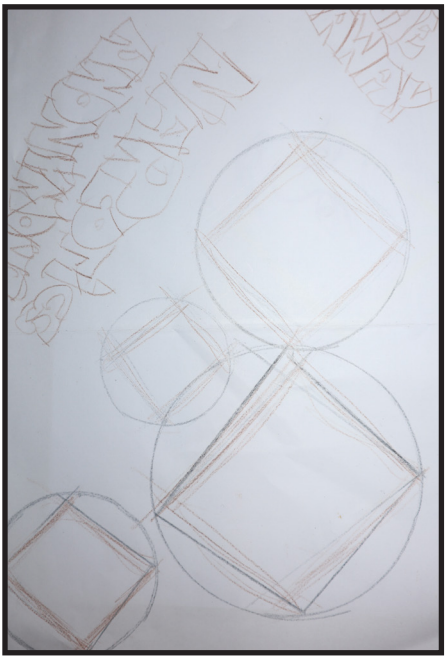
My addiction doesn't always have to control me anymore.

Now I can let go, and let God.

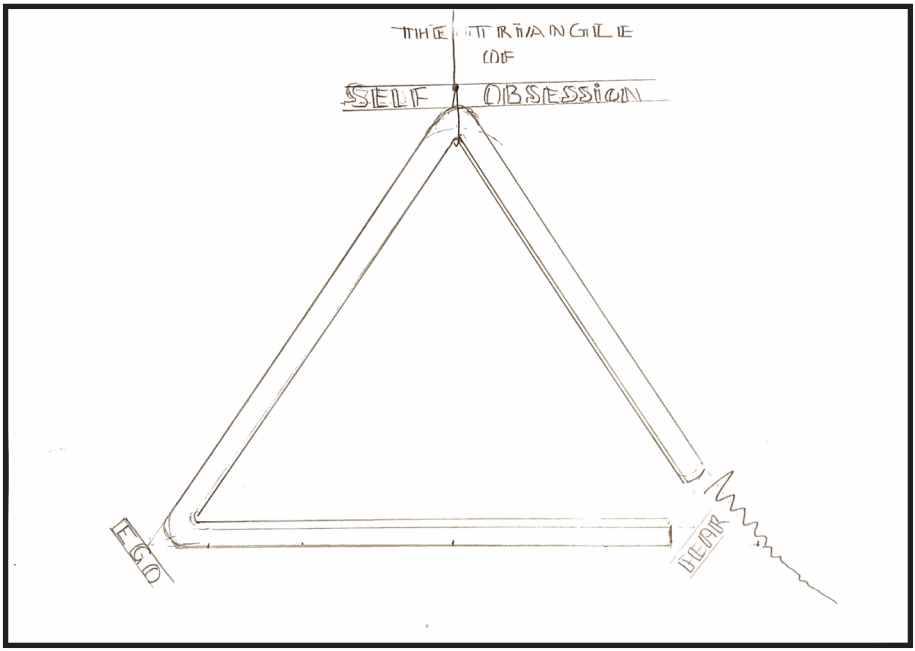
Coming Home at the EFSC

Every year, the road to the EFCS — the struggle inside. “No, I don’t want to. No, it’s a waste of time, I’ve got a lot going on. No, I’ve got a lot of better things to do.”

Calling my sponsor to be honest about what’s going on inside — the resistance, etcetera. By opening up and hearing that it’s always the same thoughts... the thoughts are there: the feeling of coming home. At the EFCS, seeing the family again, there where you are loved and can just be yourself. Getting the hugs, the good food, loving the people. So come to the EFCS 2027! And come home!







EFSC

Save the date

2027

9 - 12 SEPTEMBER

AMBT DELDEN

KROEZE DANNE

NAHELP.NL

NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS

UNITY DAY

FREE RECOVERY



Saturday
14th November

11:00 AM -
9:00 PM

All Hallows Church,
Landseer Road,
Ipswich IP3 0EN

www.freerecovery.org.uk

FSC 2027

Fellowship Service Conference for NA

Registration information

When: June 25th through June 27th, 2027 - **Arrival time: 5pm**

Location: Hamburg, PA:
Olivet Mountain Camp
1540 Mountain Ave.
Hamburg, PA 19526

Cost: $140.00 per person

Price includes all meals (and lodging if needed). There is no registration fee; all money goes directly to pay for the facility and food.

Write checks payable to: Historical Perspective Group
For more information:
Contact Historical Perspective Group
(484) 951 3305
Ask for Bill or e-mail: matrixmatclub@yahoo.com

Send checks to: A.S.I.S. for NA
P.O. Box 4404
Allentown, PA 18105
Write checks payable to "Historical Perspective Group of NA"
(Bring sheets, towels, and soap — everything else is provided)

Name: _____ E-mail: _____
Address: _____
City: _____ State: _____
Zip: _____ Phone Number: (____) _____
Group Name: _____
Register by June 10, 2026
Amount: $140.00 Check No.: _____

Adversity does not build character, it reveals it
MORE WILL BE REVEALED

NAHELP.ORG

Upcoming Events

EFSC NETHERLANDS
Date: September 10th thru 13th , 2026
Ambt Delden, The Netherlands

Annual Fellowship Service Conference for N.A.
Date: June 25th thru June 27th, 2027
Hamburg, PA



Weblinks

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WE NEED YOUR INPUT!

Please send your articles, event information, comics or other input to:

info@nahelp.org

Your Fellowship Magazine
Share... and be shared with..

Like it was when NA was new and young
and life or death intense:
You matter to us so we will tell you the
truth as we know it with nothing held back.

THE NEW/OLD NA WAY

"... so that no addict seeking recovery need ever die..."
We publish your input -- the opinions presented are not necessarily those of the New/Old NA Way or Anonymi Foundation